

CDN Incident Alert: 0086. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	MD Fake Polls, Real Threat: Uncovering Russian Information Warfare Infrastructure Ahead of Elections in Moldova	10/09/2025

Summary

- A cluster of domains (vocepentru.com; vocepentru.eu, vocea-mea.online) posed as an “independent online survey project” while imitating PAS branding and promoting biased anti-EU and pro-Russian survey questions. The survey posed questions about sensitive topics, such as minority rights, language use, and economic insecurity, in a way that amplified polarization.
- Technical artifacts link the network to the Russian charity fund “Promotion of Social Projects.”
- The websites framed EU integration as economically harmful for Moldova, elevated pro-Russian talking points, and cast pro-EU politicians as untrustworthy.
- The websites garnered limited organic engagement. Traffic spiked over three days in July, and referrals from Russian traffic-generation domains indicate artificial amplification.
- The apparent aim of the deceptive sites was to polarize Moldovan society and undermine trust in Moldova’s pro-EU governance. The maligned actors created inauthentic websites with localized content posing as an independent survey platform. The websites underwent several iterations and employed various methods, including the use of external trackers, to bypass detection.
- Recommendations include rapid takedown by escalating the request to website hosts and registrars; monitoring social media platforms for cases promoting look-alike civic sites and covert telemetry; and proactive public guidance on manipulative “surveys.”

Incident

In July and August, malign actors registered and iterated multiple “survey” sites, including vocea-mea.online (registered on July 7, [archived](#)), vocepentru.eu (registered on July 10, [archived](#)), vocepentru.online ([registered](#) on July 10), [vocepentru.com](#) (registered on August 1, [archived](#)), and [vocepentru.space](#) ([registered](#) on August 1). The .com site mimicked Moldova’s PAS party [website’s](#) branding and language and referenced the left-wing Future of Moldova Party (Partidul Viitorul Moldovei – PVM) using the phrase “Răspunsuri pentru Viitorul Moldovei” (“Answers for the Future of Moldova”) in the website’s headline. The “Take the survey” button was activated on August 14, and the (still inactive) “Survey results” button appeared on August 18, 2025.

The survey comprised 13 items, including questions about respondents’ demographics (such as age and education). It used forced yes/no answers, with leading language that linked EU accession to price hikes and harm to local producers. A question about whether respondents supported the “total prohibition of the Russian language in Moldova” exemplified the bias of the survey.

A website analysis revealed that the sites were connected to an external telemetry backend that utilized hidden pixels and scripts to track users. The domains within the dataset were connected using reverse IP searches and examining asset reuse. Early website versions used VK and Mail.ru trackers; later versions shifted to custom tracking to evade detection.

Code reuse and a shared VK pixel ID linked the campaign infrastructure to research-online[.]ru domain, which according to the [information](#) on the website, is operated by the [Russian charity fund “Promotion of Social Projects”](#) (“Продвижение Социальных Проектов”). The fund, reportedly well-resourced, [previously ran](#) large-scale pro-Kremlin ads on VKontakte.

There is no evidence of broad organic social media promotion, and social media was not used to boost the visibility of the vocepentru websites (one [post on Reddit](#) referred to vocepentru as suspicious). On the other hand, backlink analysis (referrals) indicated that artificial traffic sources predominantly came from websites used for SEO optimization. One website was [flagged](#) as malicious.

The [www.vocepentru.eu](#) page was discussed on July 23 on the [Facebook channel of the anti-disinformation initiative WatchDog.MD](#), which encouraged users to troll the survey and fill it out with false information. The call

to action appears to have been well-received, as the post garnered 1,700 likes, 183 comments, and its [video](#) reached 47,000 views (as of May 18, 2025).

Systemic violation assessment

The operation targeted electoral attitudes in Moldova, aiming to depress support for EU integration and undermine trust in a pro-EU government; vulnerable groups are instrumentalized in divisive survey questions.

Both content (biased, emotionally loaded survey items; impersonative branding) and tactics (inauthentic and hidden telemetry; domain rotation; artificial traffic) constitute information manipulation.

Possible violations analogous to deceptive political advertising, impersonation and fraud, and unlawful data tracking are applicable if local law equates hidden telemetry and misrepresentation with offline fraud. A thorough legal review is required.

Narrative

Meta narratives: EU integration harms Moldova; pro-EU leaders cannot be trusted.

Sub-narratives: EU membership raises prices and hurts local farmers; Linguistic rights are “under threat”; Diaspora voting requires restriction; Union with Romania and support to Ukraine are distractions from domestic woes.

Impact

Reach: Short, inorganic traffic spike over three days in July; referrals from Russian traffic-generation domains; minimal social media and search visibility; A WatchDog.MD video about vocepentru.eu garnered 47,000 video views, 1,700 likes, and 183 comments.

Outcome: N/A

Key Objectives and Behaviours

Objective: [T0135.004: Polarize](#) – divisive survey opposes EU membership against Moldova’s “sovereign” path.

Objective: [T0135: Undermine](#) – erode trust in Moldova’s pro-EU governance and electoral processes via deceptive “independent” surveys.

[T0049.007: Inauthentic Sites Amplify News and Narratives](#) – multiple coordinated domains (vocepentru.*; vocea-mea.online) used manipulative “survey” content.

[T0101: Create Localized Content](#) – Romanian-language used, Moldova-specific political issues (EU accession, diaspora voting, Transnistria) exploited.

[T0121.001: Bypass Content Blocking](#) – migration from overt VK and Mail.ru trackers to hidden pixel and script on alternate domains to evade detection.

[T0143.002: Fabricated Persona](#) – posing as an independent “Vocea Mea” (“My Voice”) survey platform and mimicking PAS branding to gain trust.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions Taken: In-depth report examining this activity to be published in mid-September, with dissemination partners including Moldovan partners like ZdG.

Recommendations: Notify website hosts and registrars to disable telemetry endpoints and associated domains; alert Moldovan authorities and election bodies about deceptive political surveying; platforms to detect and label look-alike civic and political sites and non-transparent tracking; civil society and media to publish rapid explainers on manipulative online polls; encourage reporting and archiving of similar sites; conduct public guidance campaigns in Moldova ahead of electoral milestones.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	FIMI Assessment
TBD	Russia	Upon request	Jakub Kubś, GLOBSEC Martyna Hoffman, Fundacja Odpowiedzialna Polityka	Web domains; VK ads; tracking infrastructure.	High certainty

